

CHANGE REQUEST INTAKE & APPROVAL SOP

Illustrative portfolio sample - fictional company, requests, systems, roles, links, and approval rules

PROCESS DOCUMENTATION SAMPLE

A clear path from business request to executed document

This SOP gives commercial, operations, legal, finance, and signing teams one consistent way to submit, validate, approve, document, and close a change to an existing customer agreement.

DOCUMENT OWNER

Contract Operations

PRIMARY USERS

Operations + Legal

REVIEW CYCLE

Every 6 months

PROCESS AT A GLANCE

1	2	3	4	5	6
Submit request	Validate intake	Review terms	Approve change	Route signature	Archive & close

WHEN TO USE THIS PROCESS	MINIMUM INTAKE REQUIREMENTS
• Pricing, scope, staffing, term, or service changes • Updates to an existing order or statement of work • Commercial changes requiring a signed record	• Customer and current agreement • Requested change and effective date • Approved business terms and internal owner • Supporting pricing or scope details

PORTFOLIO ATTRIBUTION

Co-created by Hans Bragas in collaboration with Legal and Operations. Hans contributed to documenting the workflow, clarifying intake requirements, organizing review steps, and improving handoffs.

PROCEDURE

Six controlled stages with clear evidence and ownership

STEP	ACTIVITY	OWNER	CONTROLLED ACTION	REQUIRED EVIDENCE
1	Submit the request	Business Requester	Open a request ticket and provide the current agreement, proposed change, effective date, business justification, customer contact, and supporting commercial details.	Complete ticket with source documents attached
2	Validate intake	Contract Operations	Check that the request is complete, identify the affected document, confirm the authorized internal owner, and return incomplete submissions with specific questions.	Intake accepted or returned for completion
3	Prepare and review	Contract Operations + Legal	Select the appropriate template, prepare the initial draft, compare it with the existing agreement, and route legal or specialist questions to the appropriate reviewer.	Reviewed draft and documented open issues
4	Obtain approvals	Business + Finance + Legal	Record approvals required by the change. Pricing, credits, scope, risk, privacy, or security issues must be approved by the responsible team before signature routing.	Approval evidence attached to the request
5	Route for signature	Contract Operations	Confirm signer names and email addresses, prepare the final execution copy, route through the approved e-signature platform, and monitor completion.	Fully executed document
6	Archive and close	Contract Operations	Save the executed copy in the contract repository, update the request and contract tracker, notify stakeholders, and document any follow-up obligations.	Complete audit trail and closed request

STOP AND ESCALATE WHEN

The requested change conflicts with the governing agreement or an existing obligation.	The business request lacks an approved commercial decision or an authorized owner.
Privacy, security, employment, tax, insurance, or regulatory questions are identified.	A counterparty requests non-standard language or signature before approvals are complete.

ROLES & COMPLETION CHECKLIST

A practical reference for consistent execution and ownership

RESPONSIBILITIES

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Business Requester	Provides complete instructions, supporting documents, business approval, and an authorized customer contact.
Contract Operations	Owns intake quality, drafting coordination, request updates, approval evidence, signature routing, tracking, and archiving.
Legal / Specialist Reviewers	Review issues within their expertise, provide guidance, and approve or escalate non-standard terms.
Finance / Commercial Approver	Confirms pricing, credits, billing, revenue, and other commercial impacts before execution.
Authorized Signer	Signs only the final approved document through the designated execution channel.

COMPLETION CHECKLIST

☐ Request identifies the current governing agreement and requested effective date.	☐ Business terms and affected services are clear and approved.
☐ Required Legal, Finance, Privacy, Security, or other reviews are recorded.	☐ Final document matches the approved version and signer details are confirmed.
☐ Executed document is saved in the designated contract repository.	☐ Request tracker, ticket status, and stakeholders are updated.
☐ Ongoing notice, billing, implementation, or renewal obligations are assigned.	

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Field	Illustrative value	Field	Illustrative value
SOP owner	Contract Operations	Version	1.0
Approved by	Legal and Operations	Next review	Six months after approval

CONFIDENTIALITY & USE

This document was recreated for portfolio demonstration. It does not reproduce proprietary wording, links, customer data, internal systems, exact approval rules, or confidential records from the original employer. It is an administrative workflow example and is not legal advice.